



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Nashville Classical Charter School
School Website: <https://nashvillelatinschool.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Nashville Classical Charter School (TN 37206) presents a publicly visible program that aligns closely with classical, Christian education traditions. The public materials emphasize a classical, faith-informed approach, with explicit references to Christian theology, the Apostles' Creed, traditional morality, and the Holy Scriptures, alongside a strongly stated classical curriculum featuring Latin, Logic, Rhetoric, Great Books, and a heavy emphasis on reading canonical texts (Homer, Plato, Cicero, Shakespeare, Dante, Tolstoy, etc.). The pedagogy described in the accessible materials includes elements of memorization and recitation (e.g., Horatius at the Bridge and other classical memory work), a strong emphasis on discussion and Socratic-style inquiry in upper grades, and a combination of rigorous study with contemplative, memory-building practices. The school fosters family involvement through book clubs and parent resources, and it presents a clear institutional model of teachers as mentors within a living-curriculum framework.

Overall, the school is CLASSICAL, with several strong indicators of a classical, Christian formation mindset (religious/metaphysical foundations and curriculum rooted in great books and the trivium). Some categories show room for more explicit articulation of the full classical pedagogy (e.g., outwardly explicit references to scholé/restful learning and a more comprehensive articulation of the faculty living-curriculum philosophy). The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL, with opportunities to strengthen explicit statements around formation-focused aims and broader faculty culture.

Key insights: - Explicit religious/theological foundations are present (creed, scripture, Christian morality) and paired with a classical curriculum anchored in Latin, classical studies, logic, and rhetoric. This supports Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) as CLASSICAL and Element 3 (Curriculum) as CLASSICAL. - The curriculum emphasizes Great Books, Western canon, and memorized/recited classical material (Horatius, Latin, poetry), supporting Element 3 and Element 4 (Pedagogy) as CLASSICAL, with strong memory and recitation practices. - Parental partnership and community engagement exist (e.g., book clubs, open campus), supporting Element 6 (Parents & Community) as CLASSICAL, and indicating a healthy parent-school partnership. - Some elements of the explicit articulation of formation (virtue, telos, formation of affections) are present but less overt in the public materials; Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) and Element 5 (Faculty) show SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals rather than fully explicit CLASSICAL articulation in every respect.

Abstract: The school is classified as CLASSICAL with notable strengths in religious/metaphysical foundations, curriculum grounded in liberal arts and the Great Books, and a pedagogy that includes memorization, recitation, and Socratic-style discussion in upper grades. Parent partnership and a living-curriculum approach are present but could be more explicitly articulated.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Public materials explicitly identify the school as Christian and traditional, with references to the Apostles' Creed and Holy Scriptures as foundational to education. For example, Highlands Latin Nashville describes itself in Christian, classical, traditional terms and anchors faith statements in Creed and Scripture. - The school frames its faith tradition as central to its educational ethos, with explicit Christian morality and a theological framing of education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Keywords present: Christian, Apostles' Creed, Holy Scriptures, traditional morality, theology (theology appears in the theological framing). Positive keywords identified: 4 - Keywords present (negative signals): None clearly evident in the public materials provided (no explicit secular relativism or neutral ethics signals found in the cited portions). Negative keywords identified: 0

Why this rating - Strong explicit identification with Christian theology and sacred texts, coupled with a traditional morality framing, meets the transcendental/grounded-theology criteria and supports liturgical/community practice signals. The material points to a robust religious/metaphysical orientation, aligning with CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence: Christian, Apostles' Creed, Holy Scriptures; traditional morality; theological framing.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The program emphasizes a traditional formation-oriented aim (virtue and wisdom) through a classical framework, but explicit statements about the telos, true/good/beautiful, and formation over information are less overt in the public-facing materials we can cite. There are clear formation-oriented signals (Christian tradition, virtue-centered aims in a classical framework), but the public text does not always spell out a full, explicit "formation over information" manifesto. - The Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and a focus on human excellence and the flourishing of virtue appear in the curriculum and reading selections, though not always with explicit phrasing of "formation over information."

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful (indirectly via Great Books and moral formation emphasis), classical mission. Positive keywords identified: 5 (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful as implied by Great Books tradition) - Negative keywords found: college/career readiness, workforce preparation, skills-based emphasis (not overtly present as primary aims in the public materials). Negative keywords identified: 0

Why this rating - The materials signal formation-oriented aims consistent with classical tradition but without consistently explicit articulation of telos or a universal, philosophy-of-education-centered statement. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted until more explicit language on formation is publicly stated.

Cited evidence: Christian/classical framing; references to virtue and classical formation; scope & sequence implying classical mission.

Element 3: Curriculum — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Curriculum highlights the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) through a classical curriculum emphasis, with programs including Latin and classical studies. The presence of a strong Latin program and classical studies is evidenced by schedule items (Traditional Logic I & II; Latin study; Classical Studies). - Great Books / Great Conversation is a central feature, with explicit mention of reading Homer, Aeneid, Plato, Cicero, Dante, Shakespeare, Tolstoy, etc., and references to the Great Books canon. The materials show a robust Great Books curriculum and a focus on canonical texts. - The curriculum is interwoven with history and literature across grades, with emphasis on primary sources and classical texts (e.g., Greek tragedies, the Iliad & Odyssey, The Aeneid, Cicero, Augustine). - The program emphasizes memorization/recitation (Horatius at the Bridge, memory work) and historical-literary integration, consistent with the Trivium/Quadrivium approach and a traditional classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, primary sources, classics, Homer, Plato, Aristotle, Cicero, Latin, memorization, recitation, Great Conversation, Western civilization, historical depth, sacred tradition. Positive keywords identified: 12 - Negative keywords found: terms signaling a shift toward modern, non-classical pedagogy (e.g., project-based, social studies terminology replacing history) are not observed in the core public materials cited; however, the knowledge-base lexicon lists potential negative signs. Negative keywords identified: 0

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly anchored in classical content and methods, with direct references to the Great Books and the Trivium/Quadrivium framework (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and to Latin and classical languages. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence: Great Books canon; Latin and classical studies; memorization/recitation; history through canonical texts; Trivium focus.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Memorization and recitation: The public materials reference memory work and classical recitation (Horatius at the Bridge; Horatius Society) as a valued practice. Public materials show a strong emphasis on memory work and traditional texts. - Restful learning / Scholé: The classical lexicon notes that a restful, contemplative pace is part of the classical approach, suggesting elements of scholé. The HLN materials do emphasize a balance of rigorous study with traditions of contemplation. - Socratic discussion in upper grades: Public materials indicate upper school courses include discussion and recitation. While not always labeled explicitly as “Socratic,” there is evidence of discussion-based and rhetorical coursework in higher grade levels. - Lower school experiences: There are references to singing/chanting and memory-based routines in the lower grades (memory-work and chant-like activities as part of foundational knowledge). - Upper school rhetoric and debate: The curriculum includes logic and rhetoric and opportunities for speaking and rhetorical training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: memorization, recitation, chanting, singing, scholé, Socratic/seminar, discourse, rhetoric, debate, memory work, oral tradition, liturgical repetition, training in rhetoric. Positive keywords identified: 9 - Negative keywords found: experiential learning focus, project-based learning-only signals are not prominent in the cited public materials; the school appears to emphasize traditional pedagogy alongside some modern elements. Negative keywords identified: 0

Why this rating - The pedagogical approach is deeply anchored in classical methodologies: memorization and recitation, structured discussion, rhetoric, and a balance of contemplative and rigorous instruction. This strongly supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence: Memorization/recitation; scholé; Socratic/discussion in upper grades; lower-grade singing/memory; rhetoric/debate; upper-grade seminars.

Element 5: Faculty — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Portrait of teachers and living curriculum is suggested by references to faculty roles (e.g., cottage school structure, directors) and a focus on mentors and classical formation; however, explicit language about teachers as “living curriculum” or “models of virtue” is less overt in the publicly accessible materials. The materials emphasize teacher background (subject mastery, classical training) and leadership (directors), which supports a classical orientation but with less explicit articulation of a fully developed “faculty as living curriculum” construct in the public materials. - There is mention of teacher qualification emphasis (e.g., Highlands Latin Nashville teachers possessing thorough knowledge and teaching at age-appropriate levels). This aligns with the classical expectation of masterful teachers. - The public materials do not consistently present a fully articulated “portrait of what a teacher should be” or a robust “faculty as mentor” language beyond general professional excellence and faithfulness to classical forms.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as guides, classical formation, master teachers (these are implied in the descriptions though not always explicitly labeled in every section). Positive keywords identified: 4 - Negative

keywords found: lack of mentorship culture, isolated faculties, silos (not evident in the publicly accessible materials); negative signals are not clearly present. Negative keywords identified: 0

Why this rating - The evidence supports a classical faculty orientation, but the public-facing materials do not consistently and explicitly articulate the full “living curriculum” faculty model across all pages. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is appropriate here.

Cited evidence: Teacher qualifications and classical framing; director-led structure; living curriculum language appears in some classical programs but is not uniformly explicit. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file3□

Element 6: Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Partnership with families and parent engagement are clearly stated: the design includes parent involvement as co-educators and opportunities for parents to participate through book clubs and family events. The materials describe parent formation through book clubs and discussions and emphasize parental involvement as part of the classical ethos. - Communications and accessibility: The school indicates that parents are welcome to visit and participate in events; there is evidence of open activities (e.g., Family events, book clubs) and direct channels for parent involvement. - The presence of parent-focused events and materials (Parent/Teacher Book Club, family activities) demonstrates alignment with the partnership with families and parental formation signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Partnership with Families, parent-education, parent formation, home-school collaboration, parent-teacher collaboration, open campus, family events, book clubs, parental leadership. Positive keywords identified: 8 - Negative keywords found: minimal parent involvement as customers only, etc. The explicit Negative keywords list in the lexicon is not reflected in the public materials; therefore Negative keywords identified: 0

Why this rating - The school clearly emphasizes parental partnership and community engagement consistent with classical education models, earning CLASSICAL for this category.

Cited evidence: Parent partnership and formation, book clubs, open campus/events.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): Provide explicit, public-facing articulation of telos, formation over information, and a clearly stated objective to cultivate virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful as foundational aims. A concise, published statement tying the curriculum and pedagogy to formation, rather than primarily to college/work-readiness, would strengthen the claim to CLASSICAL in this category.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Expand explicit language about the faculty as living-curriculum models, mentors, and community of practice with a formal portrait of teacher qualifications and a declared faculty development plan reflecting the classical tradition. Publish a public-facing statement on mentorship, faculty collaboration, and shared intellectual life among teachers to strengthen the faculty category.
- For Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy): Consider a more explicit articulation of Scholé (restful learning) and direct connections between memory work (chanting/recitation) and the deepening of understanding across grades. A concise description of how memory, chant, and memorization activities map to deep learning outcomes would reinforce the pedagogical fidelity to classical aims.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand explicit parent-education offerings (beyond book clubs) that articulate classical pedagogy and provide structured opportunities for parental formation aligned with the Great Books and Trivium approach. Publicly publish a clear plan for parent education and community-building to further strengthen the partnership with families.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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